



POWER & CORRIDORS × NERA · FORESIGHT DESK

Supply-Chain Disruption Outlook

A 30–90 day outlook on the chokepoints, tariffs and corridors shaping global trade risk — and what they mean for your business.

Issue: June 2026 · **Type:** Sector / Supply-Chain Risk Outlook

Prepared by: NERA Strategic Insights Lab · **Classification:** NERA-Unrestricted

For: Power & Corridors readership — logistics, insurance, trade finance, procurement & corporate risk

1 • Executive Outlook

Global supply chains face a **synchronized, three-vector shock** over the next 30–90 days. None is, on its own, catastrophic — but together they raise freight costs, lengthen lead times and concentrate risk on a handful of corridors and product groups.

- **Strait of Hormuz** — Gulf shipping remains severely throttled despite first-round US–Iran talks; the energy and freight risk has not cleared.
- **Tariffs (US–China)** — A 30% tariff regime is holding under a 60-day pause; light-manufacturing imports sit at elevated disruption risk into the holiday season.
- **Paper, pulp & allied goods** — Layered trade-remedy actions and rerouting put these imports at the highest near-term disruption probability in the set.
- **Freight & insurance** — Any combination of the above feeds directly into container rates, war-risk premiums and inventory planning.

Bottom line: plan for elevated-but-manageable disruption as the base case, with a credible (~1-in-4) escalation path that would push container freight up 40–60% and squeeze holiday inventories. The window to act — re-route, pre-book, hedge, secure alternate sourcing — is now.

2 • Key Facts

Vector	Current reading	What's driving it
Strait of Hormuz	~94% below normal transit (~5 vessels/day vs ~92 baseline)	Iran tensions; first-round US–Iran talks in Switzerland reportedly suspended after countervailing threats
US–China tariffs	30% tariffs in force under an 11 June 60-day pause	Small/midsize importers cancelling China orders; industry bodies warning of holiday shortages
Paper & pulp	~70% next-month disruption probability	US antidumping injury determinations (paper bags, 2026); a Brazil/Norway dissolving-pulp case reported in final phase; tariff rerouting
China / Hong Kong light mfg	50–59% disruption probability	Tariff-driven order cancellations and rerouting in toys, leather and consumer goods
Copper (Chile)	Linked secondary signal	Tracks the broader trade-friction theme; lower confidence than the lead vectors

Readings are NERA's live signals as of mid-June 2026; chokepoint transit from maritime tracking data. Figures are directional and refreshed continuously on the Foresight Desk.

3 • 30–90 Day Outlook

Three scenarios, with probabilities as analyst estimates rather than precise forecasts:

Most likely — sustained strain, no breakout

~55%

Hormuz stays heavily throttled but avoids full re-closure; the tariff pause holds; paper/pulp disruption partly materialises. Freight elevated, lead times longer, but no systemic spike.

Escalation — the tail that hurts

~25%

Hormuz re-closure, US–China tariff escalation after the 60-day window, and paper-mill capacity exits combine. Container freight +40–60%; holiday inventories (toys, leather) squeezed; insurance accumulation rises.

Improvement — de-escalation path

~20%

US–Iran talks resume and steady the Gulf; the tariff pause is extended or converted to a deal. Disruption probabilities ease across the board.

4 • Business Implications

Logistics operators. Expect continued Gulf re-routing (Cape of Good Hope), longer Asia–Europe transit and tighter capacity. Pre-book space, diversify carriers and corridors, and build buffer stock on exposed lanes.

Insurers & brokers. War-risk and marine premiums stay elevated on Gulf/Red Sea routing; watch accumulation and price the re-closure tail explicitly. Note that the largest losses often come from operational/technical incidents, not only headline geopolitics.

Banks & trade finance. Re-routing shifts counterparties and lengthens tenors on affected corridors. Stress-test exposure to paper/pulp and China light-manufacturing flows, and to clients dependent on Hormuz energy throughput.

Procurement teams. Paper/pulp and light manufacturing carry the highest near-term disruption risk. Secure alternate sourcing, pull forward critical orders, and treat the tariff-pause expiry as a hard planning date.

5 • Watch Indicators

Indicator	Threshold to watch	What it signals
Hormuz daily transits	Sustained >30/day → easing · <10/day	Re-closure risk / Gulf supply shock

US-Iran talks status	Resumption vs collapse + military rhetoric	De-escalation or escalation of the lead vector
US-China 60-day tariff pause	Extension/deal vs lapse ($\approx$ early Aug)	Relief or tariff escalation into peak season
USITC trade-remedy rulings (paper/pulp)	Final affirmative determinations	Confirms paper/pulp disruption
Container freight indices (SCFI / Drewry)	+20% week-on-week	Stress building across corridors
Global supply-chain pressure (GSCPI)	Rising above $+2\sigma$	Systemic, not single-corridor, pressure

6 • Methodology Note

NERAI combines **import-flow disruption modelling** (trained on US import data, 2013–present), **open-source event monitoring**, **maritime chokepoint transit data** and **analyst review**. Probabilities are calibrated model estimates, reviewed by an analyst, and should be read as directional rather than precise. The Foresight Desk refreshes the underlying signals continuously.

Technical appendix. Disruption model as-of 1 April 2026 · out-of-sample Brier 0.101 · calibration error (ECE) 0.026 · Precision@10% 0.637. Confidence by vector — Hormuz operational disruption: moderate-to-high (subject to transit verification); paper/pulp: high model signal / moderate source confidence; China–Hong Kong tariff disruption: moderate. This outlook is informational and not financial, legal or investment advice.